



Speaker 1 - 00:00

Learning to go with the flow is a part of this. Oh, I hear somebody now. Theater. I hear somebody now. Oh, just. Yeah, you guys are just silenced. No, sorry. I'm thinking it was them in the other room. They're sitting up. I really do wish I could be there with you guys. This would be so much more beneficial, at least for me. I hope this is beneficial for you. You guys, I do a lot of Zoom meetings in my work and actually attend AA meetings via Zoom, and I actually did a meditation retreat via Zoom recently. So you can be done, but it takes, you know, a few different things. Maybe I'll talk about that once we get them set. I'm just waiting for them to give me a thumbs up that they can hear me there in the room, down in theater.



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Can you hear me, theater? I am talking to theater. And I'm sorry. If I was listening to this, I'd probably be annoyed. Okay, I'm going to talk to you guys until you know that you can hear something from me. And then I'm not hearing them. So they have to select the microphone and get some volume on the. The display. And I. I see you guys. I do. I hear you. Great. Can you. You guys can hear me now? Okay, great. I actually hear you better than island, so that's wonderful. And. Okay, so what's that? You could. What do you need? I'm gonna keep talking until you tell me you're okay, that everything's honky dory or you're. That we need to do a little bit more adjusting. So are we okay there in theater? Oh, gotcha. I see that. Thank you.



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So you're hearing me from the laptop then, huh? Okay, you should be able to hear me through the. Through the tv, which will give you more volume, actually. But, yeah, I guess, yeah, I could see you. I'd want to be able to see you if I can. Once we get this set, we'll have to remember, so we could do this in the future. Okay. Yeah, still, I'm just. You guys seeing me on the screen yet? Just in the tab, but. Okay, then that's something you guys can test after this, if you're not to get it on the screen. So why don't we just go with this right now? I can. I can see you guys. Can you see me? Okay. Oh, okay. They can make that.



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So if you go to your view, which is the top right, you can select speaker view, and then you'll. And then you'll see me waving to you. Yeah, top right, it should say speaker view. Okay, we got a couple of new folks, they're rearing to go. Come on, I'm playing. So it looks like we'll have. Yeah, okay. All right. Okay. Yeah. After this, you guys can practice a text, connecting it to the display. But for right now, this is at least we're communicating better than the last two or three times. Okay. So I'm going to try to change transition here in my mind here to actually connecting with you guys and not worrying about technology. And I work in the technology field, so I deal with this all the time.



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So there are a few of you that I haven't met yet and so going and. But there are. There are a couple that do. So I'm just gonna give a. Just a few minutes maybe of kind of an introduction on the type of meditation and the. What I am, I promote. And then we'll do some meditating and we'll see if that goes very well. Then what we'll do is I'll try to leave a few minutes at the end. Okay. So you guys down in theater, are you still tuning? Okay. Alrighty. So as I was mentioning when were starting to. To get a little closer that how uncertain life is and learning to roll with the punches, right, without having, without.



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Without our emotions getting out of control, which usually that's something that us addicts and alcoholics are

working with the time, all the time trying to change the way we feel and. And not be. Not be accepting of things as they are. And so this practice that I am going to teach you is a way for basically dealing with life on life terms and changing the way we not necessarily perceive the world, but to look at it through a different eyes. And we are very sensitive and there's a tendency for us to want things to be agreeable things to the things that we like to go on, the things that are pleasing and to push away things that we don't, like, reject. Right? So this is push and pull on life. That's attention.



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And so this is what causes conflicts within us because, you know, we want things to be smooth and we want to. We all want to be happy. And that's the goal is for us to all. We want to be happy. And we're looking to organize the way our external life is so that it pleases us. But what happens is that life is not easy. Things are always changing. We don't control them. And actually this brings out something that I don't really talk to you guys about, like what can we really control? There's very Little we can control in life, and yet we keep trying to manage it. So this brings us stress and suffering. So this practice of mindfulness is where we recognize what's going on and we have a lens that we look at this, at, which I'll talk about in a second.



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So there's this recognition and there's acceptance of what's going on. So the way we go about that is that we are turning towards what we actually directly experience. And so what I mean by that is we notice that we're in our bodies, right? So we're feeling our bodies, we're feeling the sensations of the body. So those are things that we directly know what we don't know and what we normally are trying to manage is why is this happening? What's the cause, right? Or judging that we don't like it, right? And so we are struggling with it. So we're basically making something that's already stress in itself. We're making it worse, right, by our reactions to it.



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So this idea of having peace, getting peace in our lives, being able to manage the way we feel is this recognition, this knowing and this acceptance of what is happening. And then what that means is this basically through that we're. This acceptance, then things have a nature going away on their own. You don't have to force things to go away. In fact, the more effort we put into things, actually, the more we actually instigate things and make them worse, right? It's like you have a wound and you're pouring salt in it. So this idea that I'm going to push and ask and try to get across to you over and over is just a simple recognition of what's going on. So remembering, knowing what's going on, what you're experiencing it, and just this compassionate awareness of it. Now I might introduce the word compassionate.



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That's a result of it. But really all you do has to do is recognize what's going on over and over. Just this recognition and this allowing, okay? Then of course, then as a result of that, then we get to see this reactionary mind, this mind that is not able to sit still, doesn't like what it's experiencing, wants, is bored, wants to experience something else, right? And all of those are things that we can experience. So when we're meditating, we're actually. The mind is a mirror, our being. So this is okay. We end up taking things personal. Like I'm fidgety, I'm impatient, I'm angry, I'm this. And we turn that around and we start to recognize that this is just the nature of what all human beings do, right? This is the nature of the mind. It's a judging mind, right?



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It is perceptive and it recognizes what's going on. And so when you could see this, there actually gets to be a little bit of distance between you and your experience. So for instance, what I mean by that is that when you're listening to me and seeing me right now, you're actually using your vision and your hearing. Now when I'm talking, I want you to pay attention more to your. The ability to hear than. More than what I'm saying right now. Just for your first simple moment, we could just meditate on you hearing me as I talk. You know I'm hearing right. You don't even have to

listen to what I'm saying. And you know that you're hearing right. You can recognize that. But there's also the consciousness is actually recognizing what I'm saying at the same time.



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So it's kind of like if you're looking at a flower. When you notice a flower, you notice the color, that it's a. That the shape is a flower. It has petals, it has a stem, right? You're. You're knowing all this even though you're, you know, you. And you could. So when you describe this flower, there's all these aspects to it, but really it's just. You're just try. You're not describing the actual flower, you're just describing aspects of it. So you can pay attention to that. So I don't want to get too technical because it's actually more simpler than that. So what I'd like to do, if you don't mind, is for us to get right into practice and then I will kind of guide you through a meditation and I'll point out certain things. For instance, being in your body, right?



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Paying attention to your breathing. These are the things that I'm going to be. I'm going to be emphasizing. And before we start, I'll just give you a couple rules on. Well, there are no rules really, but some guidelines on meditation. You could be meditating and doing anything. If you're aware of what you're doing when you're doing it, then you can be meditating, right? That's the idea. So you could be standing, walking, sitting down, laying down. You could do it in all activities. You could be eating, you could be talking to somebody. You could be listening, as I just suggested. So as long as you're Paying attention. You're aware of what's going on while you're experiencing it. I'm going to re. Emphasize that over and over and over. Okay?



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Ask yourself whenever you're doing what's going on right now, and that doesn't mean going into the story about it and explaining it. It's just this pure recognition. So you're hearing, you're seeing, you're thinking, right? Not necessarily what you're thinking about, right? So it's about, it's this direct, direct experience. Okay? So as far as mindfulness is concerned, just a couple of aspects that I want to remind you of. So first of all, that you're interested and I hope I'm peaking interest this evening in this, you know, we're this distracted type of start that we've had, which I hope we will all be able to be peaceful and settle down as we get, as we continue on. But that you're interested in what you're doing. You're, you're so you're, you have this. There's alertness to what you're doing.



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So noticing what you're doing and paying attention to what you're doing and not everything else. But if you are paying attention to something else, then know that you're paying to something else. Attention to something else. Okay? So it's this knowing again, this knowing quality. And so mindfulness, the word for mindfulness actually is a. Is means remembering. So remembering what you're supposed to be doing as you do it. Okay? So if you remember, for instance, what I mean by that is if you get distracted by hearing a sound and you forget that you're meditating, as soon as you remember you're meditating, that's mindfulness. That's mindfulness working, saying, oh, wait a minute, I'm supposed to be meditating. And you come back to your object of meditation. Okay? So that's the third aspect of it.



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And then the fourth one I've been repeating over and over again is clearly knowing what's going on. Okay. Alrighty. So this ardency, alert, mindful and clearly knowing. So if you can just get into a position that you'll want to be in for the next few minutes. So you want to sit up and be alert so that you're wakeful and not sleeping, because that's sleeping. That's not my meditation. And then just maybe close your eyes and before you actually do anything, just take a scan of your body and feel, you know, how does your body feel? Are you tired? Are you energetic? Do you have any pains or anything, there you go. Is this just taking this kind of an inventory of where you're at right now? And then gently close your eyes and feel the pressure of the earth or the.



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On your feet and on your, your butt and your back, the cushion touching your back and propping you up. And you can. This awareness that the earth is going to hold you up. You can relax and let go and then scan maybe to see if there's any tension anywhere in the body. For instance, in your, you know, in your back or your shoulders, your neck. You can roll your shoulders, kind of let the tension go. And then after you've let go whatever, you can just maybe take a couple of deep breaths, feeling the cool air coming in and a deep exhale. This exhale is the letting go part, right? Bringing in energy, this life force that keeps us alive, and then letting go of any stress.



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And then after a couple of breaths, just come back and bring your awareness into your body and allow the energy, the sensation of your breathing to come to the forefront. Wherever you feel. Your breathing could be in the diaphragm or in the lungs expanding and contracting, or maybe in the back of the throat or at the nose, the nostrils. Cool air coming in and warm air going out. Just paying this attention to your breathing, noticing the quality of your breathing. Is your breathing relaxed or is it tight or is it shallow or is it deep? This texture of your breathing, paying attention to the quality of how you're breathing. And usually after a couple of breaths and all the. Maybe you'll start feeling other things, other sensations, maybe other pains in the body. You'll be aware of sounds or maybe aware of thinking.



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It's okay, we're not trying to stop thinking or stop the pains. It's this recognition of what we're experiencing right now. And usually this watcher, this knowing, just allowing everything has its time. It's here and then it's gone. And when it passes away, just coming back to this breathing, resting in this rhythm, noticing anything that comes up in your awareness that might take you away from the breathing, watching it just float on by like clouds. The one who knows what is going on could be a little bit distracting. If there's a lot of activity, just stay with this knowing. If it takes you away, then be just being aware of what's happening without judgment. If you are judging, then know you're judging. It's okay if you get uncomfortable and you need to move, know you're moving again.



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This knowing quality, putting the puppy back on the paper periodically, just checking back in to make sure you know this knowing quality in case you've gone on a thought train or maybe fallen asleep. It's okay. It's all normal. Setting an intention to come back, to be present for yourself, to give this gift to yourself. It. If you're finding a lot of stuff going on, you can only also incorporate the breathing into whatever's going on. You could bring this awareness of your breathing even deeper by thinking of whole body breathing, having the breath energy fill the whole body. You might get creative with this and have breath energy come in through your feet and come through your knees and into your hips and maybe out your. Your back. Or maybe having your breath energy coming through your head and come out your neck.



Speaker 1 - 30:22

Just spreading this life force throughout the body, being mindful of the breathing. As we finish this meditation portion, we'll have some discussion. I'll just make a couple of phrases here. Just keep meditating. And as I offer these phrases, just allow them to just sink into you. May you be happy. May you all be healthy. May y'all be safe. May you all enjoy peace. Okay? This will bring yourselves back slowly. And try as you come back to remember this amount of peace that you've been able to experience. I hope you've experienced some peace. Know that you can come back to this. I think that's a very important thing. This is something you can cultivate. So are there any questions at all? Okay. All righty. So I hope that was. You found this beneficial. Just. Yeah, you got a question there in theater. Oh, you're welcome.



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And I'm hoping that we'll. They will get into this groove and we can make this something that we can enjoy for the whole hour and not be so. One thing I find I just want to remind you of is that you all set an intention to be present here. So that's. That Setting an intention is a powerful thing for. For you to be. To give that gift to yourself, to just be with yourself. I would encourage you to do that all the time, as much as you can. So when you're sitting and you're noticing that you're impatient. Right. Notice that. Notice that. And use that as an opportunity for mindfulness to come and say, hey, you don't have to. You can. You have something to do now. You can be. You can. You can give some attention to your body, right?



Speaker 1 - 38:57

And your body loves that. So. So yeah, this mindfulness can be used at any time. I. It's a refuge. It's a safe place for you. If you guys noticed when you were meditating that you got this sense of knowing what was going on, right? So that sense of knowing you can actually make stronger, right? This. That's when as you're mindful, that knowing quality can increase and that actually. So knowing is not tainted. It doesn't get emotional, it doesn't get sick, it doesn't get disturbed. It's knowing. So you could turn to, and pay attention to that knowing and use it as a place of refuge. You see what I'm saying? It's a protection. And so that's a very critical thing. So for instance, if your disease is talking to you know that pay attention to it and say, oh, and watch it.



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Oh, my disease is talking to me. So what do you do with that? Maybe you come to the body and feel how it feels, right? It's tightness. Or if you're angry, noticing that tightness, right. Instead of paying attention to the story, right. You can come to these things that you really know because the story is going to just keep on going, right? You keep on. We say these stories to ourselves over and over and over and over, right? So they're endless. But we could return to the body. This is to direct knowing of what's going on. And then, guess what, that's your protection. So this idea that we can. And there's more. I didn't, I didn't want to put a lot on to you, but you can. This mindfulness of breathing is really kind of a core thing, a mindfulness of body.



Speaker 1 - 40:59

I have a lot of pain, body pain myself personally. So for instance, when I was meditating tonight, my chest is tight. I'm not breathing so well, right. So I could pay attention to that and I can pay attention to relaxing that. Right? And guess what? I slightly breathe a little bit better after I meditate because I'm relying on learning to relax that, that muscle, right? That process and just relax it and I give it more space, right. If and if, you know. So there's lots of examples that you can do that with. Okay. Okay, so I'm. We're coming to the end of our session here. Any. No. Any questions that come up at all or at all? Okay, so why don't we just sit here again for the next few minutes together? You don't even have to meditate.



Speaker 1 - 42:12

Just sit and just again connect with this and we'll just sit here for a minute. For the last, next few minutes. I'm getting used to this too, you guys. So forgive me if I'm not entertaining you or so. Okay, I think that's it for today. So this setup, we can get used to it. On Sundays, it's a slightly different room. Hopefully Friday will be okay because there's the same connection and that they posted it in the room. We could start right at 7:00 and hopefully we can have more of a more normal experience the next time. And I hope that you wish you all well and that you're safe and that you're getting a lot out of your time there at Bayside. You're learning about recovery, you're learning about yourselves and you're here in the present as much as possible. That's the only time.



Speaker 1 - 44:15

That's the only time we have is right now. And I look forward to seeing you again on Friday. Okay. Right. Good night.

Yeah, it. Okay, we're all done there.